

BPM, Governance, and POC → MVP → Production

Module 8 — Business AI in Practice · Notebook 31

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Outline

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Embedding AI in the BPM lifecycle

Name the phase before you scope the work

The Business Process Management loop: **analyse** → **design** → **execute** → **monitor** → (back to analyse). An AI feature lands at *one* of these phases.

Tip

When a stakeholder pitches an AI project, ask them to name the BPM phase. If they can't, the project isn't yet ready to scope — it's still a wish, not a feature.

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Governance — a RACI for an AI initiative

RACI, plus the AI itself as a participant

Responsible / Accountable / Consulted / Informed — extended so the *AI system* is a named actor.

- The AI is **R** (responsible) for an *individual* decision — but a human is always **A** (accountable). The AI cannot be blamed.
- **Compliance is A** for the provider choice — anything touching customer data has a compliance veto.
- **Rollback is owned by the platform team**, not the ML team: ML decides *whether* to revert; platform can actually *do* it.

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POC → MVP → Production — three projects, not three phases

Phase	Goal	What “done” looks like
POC	show the AI <i>can</i> do the task at all	a demo on a curated dataset; a go / no-go
MVP	validate that users <i>will</i> use it	a small set of real users, in their real workflow
Production	it is the <i>default</i> tool for the task	SLOs, on-call, runbooks, dashboards, change control

The most common confusion

Production is *not* “MVP, but more robust.” It is MVP *plus all the boring operational work* — monitoring, rollback, cost control, support.

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Three case studies — what real initiatives look like

- **Triage (shipped).** The classifier wasn't the hard part — ticketing integration, queue routing, and the override UI were. The provider shim and the monitoring dashboard both paid off.
- **Invoice processing (shipped).** The AI was 30 % of the project; ingestion, ERP integration, and human-review UI were the other 70 %. Trust grew from *observation*; a rule layer caught hallucinated invoice numbers.
- **Sales analytics (did *not* ship).** A solution looking for a problem — “AI for sales analytics” never produced a specific user story. *Discovery is allowed to conclude “don't build it.”*

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A one-page readiness checklist

Ten questions a technical lead uses to say “no” constructively

- 1 **User** — who *specifically* uses it?
- 2 **Task** — which task does it absorb? (name it with a verb)
- 3 **BPM phase** — analyse / design / execute / monitor?
- 4 **Pattern** × **stake** — where does the task sit on the 2×2 from Notebook 28?
- 5 **Baseline** — how is the task done today, and how long does it take?
- 6 **Success metric** — what number is measurably different in 8 weeks?
- 7 **Failure mode** — what does a wrong answer look like, and who notices?
- 8 **Rollback** — can you switch it off in 5 minutes?
- 9 **Cost model** — per-call cost, and the implied monthly bill at full scale?
- 10 **RACI** — who is A for runtime, compliance, and rollback?